more secure. Since '42 we have had a regular commercial treaty with Persia and if there were any British merchants here I have no doubt they would be well protected. One of the reasons why they do not settle here is, I think, because they know little or nothing about the country and also the long time they would be before they had their returns. The proceeds of goods sent from Manchester to be sold in Tabreez could not well arrive in Manchester in less than twelve months and the profits on common goods are often not large enough to tempt men to embark in such a trade. The returns from this country are made in a great measure in Russian gold and Silver coin which comes in to pay for Persian silk (raw) dried fruits and other merchandize. Scarcely any Persian money now goes out of the country. Perhaps about one third of the imports of European manufactures may be paid for by raw silk and other Persian produce and the rest in Russian gold and silver. And it is rather curious that this Russian coin goes back to Russia from Constantinople to pay for corn bought at Odessa. I believe that at times there is more Russian money in circulation at Khoee, a Persian frontier town, than Persian.

February 8th. I believe I told you that last summer I translated some travels in China for the Prince. I am now expecting to go to Tehran and I have had a copy of my book neatly written out and I intend to present it to the King. They say he is fond of such things and I may get something for it. You know that in Persia most books are manuscript. And altho we have fifteen printing offices[96] in Tabreez the manuscripts are much more valuable. The writing this book cost me with the gilding etc. about S 20/ so you may suppose writing is pretty cheap in Persia. The book is about the size of a novel.

(To be continued)

[96] Probably an overestimate. The first known press was established in Tabriz in 1816; in 1825 Abbas Mirza sent a Persian to Russia to learn the lithographic process and a plant was established in Tabriz, which was shortly transferred to Tehran. In 1836 the American missionaries set up a printing plant at Urumia, chiefly for publications in Syriac. The first newspaper appeared in 1851 with Edward Burgess as its managing editor. Cf. E. G. Browne, *The Persian press and Persian journalism,* Cambridge, 1914.

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